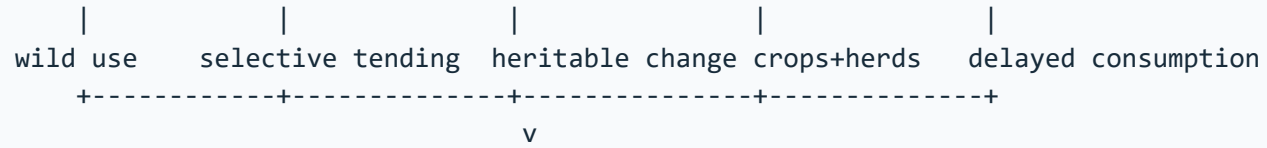


ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Food production: a regional mosaic

FORAGING -> MANAGEMENT -> DOMESTICATION -> MIXED FARMING -> SURPLUS/STORAGE



No universal package: polished stone, pottery, herding and crops appear in varied order.
Neolithic changes lifeways; Chalcolithic adds copper within stone-using economies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Domestication evidence and causal debate

PLANTS: seed-size/rachis change + weed ecology + storage + grinding tools

ANIMALS: morphology + age/sex kill profile + corrals/dung + herd demography

CAUSES: climate | population | risk buffering | social competition | niche construction

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VERDICT: domestication needs converging biological and contextual evidence.

Rice presence alone does not prove cultivation; secure date and morphology matter.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Technology-settlement-social consequence chain

polished stone + microliths + bone tools + pottery

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cultivation/herding -> houses -> storage -> longer residence -> accumulated property

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+-----+-----+

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craft/exchange growth

disease, labour load and dietary risk

|

+-----+-----+

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household differentiation and settlement hierarchy become possible, not inevitable.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Indian Neolithic regional map

NORTH-WEST: Mehrgarh -> long farming/herding sequence before Harappan urbanism

KASHMIR: Burzahom, Gufkral -> pit dwellings, bone tools, agro-pastoralism

VINDHYA/MIDDLE GANGA: Koldihwa, Mahagara, Lahuradewa -> rice/date cautions

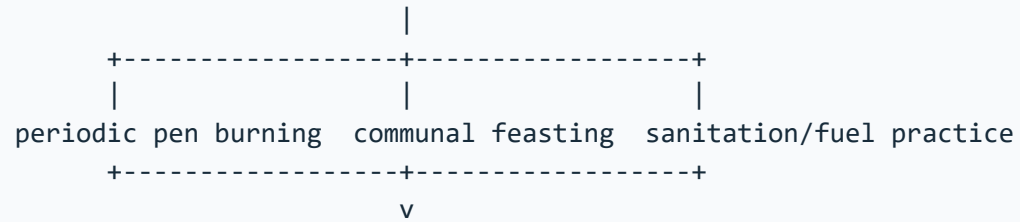
NORTH-EAST: shouldered celts and regional links; chronology remains uneven

SOUTH: Utnur, Piklihal, Tekkalakota, Hallur -> cattle, millets, ash mounds

RULE: attach each site to region + marker + chronological caution.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Ash mounds: formation-function debate

BURNT CATTLE DUNG + ENCLOSURE/SETTLEMENT CONTEXT -> SOUTH INDIAN ASH MOUND



Repeated firing and cattle centrality are strong; one exclusive ritual meaning is not.
Use Utnur and related sites as a pastoral-landscape problem, not a curiosity list.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Chalcolithic cultures: region-site-marker matrix

CULTURE/ZONE	CORE SITES	HIGH-YIELD MARKERS
Ganeshwar-Jodhpura	Ganeshwar/Jodhpura	copper craft; Harappan contact
Ahar-Banas	Ahar, Balathal, Gilund	black-red ware; copper; farming
Kayatha	Kayatha	early Malwa sequence; rich deposits
Malwa	Navdatoli, Eran, Nagda	painted ware; large villages; spread
Jorwe	Inamgaon, Nevasa	Deccan hierarchy; Late Jorwe
OCP/Copper Hoards	upper Ganga sites	association varies; no ethnic label

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Chalcolithic rural political economy

VILLAGE HOUSEHOLDS -> crop/herd production -> storage -> craft work -> exchange

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      |               |               |               |
unequal houses    risk and surplus    copper/pottery regional networks
      +-----+-----+-----+-----+
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Settlement hierarchy and differential burials may indicate inequality.

Most systems were regional and rural, not failed Harappan cities.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Decline, transformation and cultural labels

LATE JORWE/REGIONAL CHANGE: aridity + production stress + settlement reorganisation

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some abandonment + smaller settlements + mobile strategies + local continuity

CAUTION 1: archaeological culture = material pattern, not a named people.

CAUTION 2: copper use does not displace stone or prove urbanisation.

CAUTION 3: Neolithic, Chalcolithic and Harappan worlds overlap and interact.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Neolithic-Chalcolithic answer architecture

10 MARKS: define phase -> process -> two regional sites -> evidence caution

15 MARKS: transition causes -> domestication proof -> technology/settlement -> comparison

20 MARKS: mosaic chronology -> regional map -> Chalcolithic matrix -> economy/society

-> ash-mound debate -> transformation -> qualified synthesis

Use triads: region + site + marker; never write an undifferentiated site catalogue.

CLOSE: food production reorganised time, labour and settlement through diverse paths.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Evidence ladder and confidence control

EVIDENCE LADDER

1. = from source book = inference / standard knowledge = current affairs.
2. South Indian Neolithic evidence includes cattle pastoralism, polished...
3. Culture / site Region Signature marker

VERDICT: Source type controls the strength and limits of the historical claim.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Examiner traps and contested boundaries

CLOSE DISTINCTIONS

1. Evidence discipline: contested chronology and interpretation remain...
2. Contested issues Competing interpretations are attributed, evidenced...
3. Inscription and coin evidence: contemporary names, titles, claims and...

VERDICT: Qualification earns marks; false certainty is a hard failure.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Integrated answer spine and qualified conclusion

ANSWER SPINE

1. Basic completeness: every substantive owner point is retained in a...
2. Official local paper: UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Examination...
3. Verified question; inferred answer/key - not officially verified 1

VERDICT: Claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification lead to a graded...